

NOT JUST BOGGY WASTELANDS - WHY CANADA'S PEATLANDS ARE SO IMPORTANT



Peatland [1]



Icons [2]

What is peat?

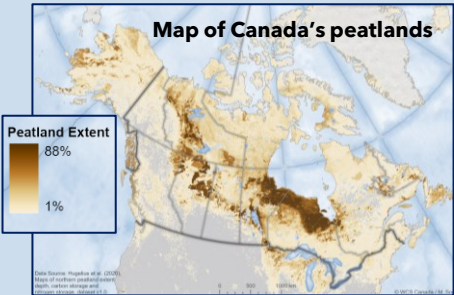
Peat is formed over thousands of years when waterlogged conditions slow down the decay of dead plants [3]. **A peatland** has at least 40 cm of accumulated peat [3]. Due to cold temperatures, peatlands are found widely across the Arctic [4].

Why are peatlands important?

Peatlands are the **world's most effective carbon sink**, storing almost **a third** of the world's carbon, while also **supporting** Arctic plants and wildlife, and insulating **permafrost** [3].

Peat stores 1/3 of global carbon

The Canadian context

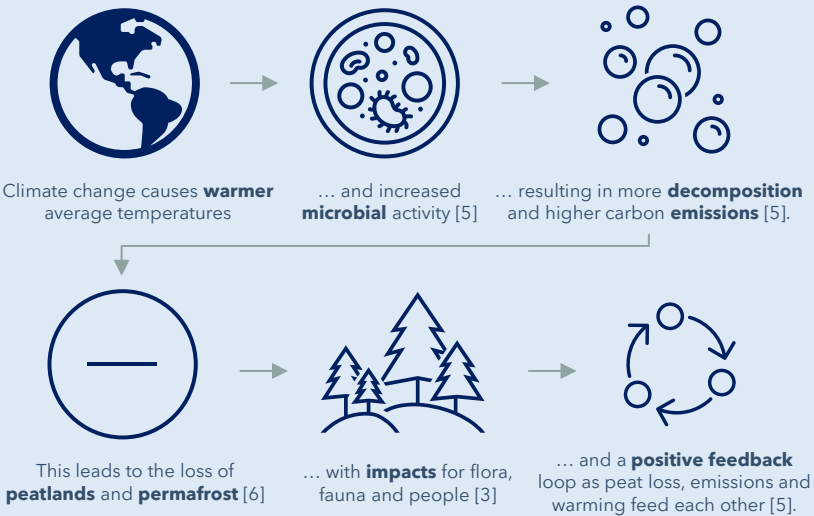


Map of Canadian Peatlands [3]

Due to the cold climate, **12%** of Canada is covered by peatlands, forming the **world's largest** peatland carbon stock [3].

Climate change is a major threat, with Indigenous peoples like the Cree and Dene facing the **loss of traditional lands** [3].

The threat of climate change

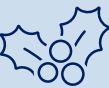


What can WE do?

The Ramsar Convention on Wetlands provides **guidance and policies** on protecting wetlands [7]. However, this will not succeed without **community** engagement - **petitions, campaigns, and education**.



Community-based management (CMB) can support local needs and traditional ecological knowledge.



Paludiculture, or agriculture on undrained peatlands, can foster communal and economic well-being while also protecting peatlands [8].



Peatland restoration, including rewetting and tree planting, promotes carbon storage and biodiversity [9].

References